

THAPSUS CARGO

The Operating Manual

A complete guide to using the iOS app and the web app, written for the people who actually run the business — customers, admins, operators, riders, and shipping agents.

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1 • Introduction

Thapsus Cargo moves parcels from the United Kingdom to Kenya. A customer ships an item from a UK retailer to our hub in Stockport, we receive it, weigh it, photograph it, screen it for prohibited goods, consolidate it onto a flight to Nairobi, clear it through customs, and a rider hands it over at the customer's door.

Two software products run that pipeline:

Product	Who it is for	Where to find it
Web app	Customers, admins, operators, shipping agents, riders, public visitors	The browser, at the deployed Railway URL.
iOS app	Customers and field staff (operators, riders, agents) who need an app on a phone	iPhone — Thapsus Cargo from the App Store.

Both apps are skinned in the same brand language (the cream-and-orange Liquid Glass look). Both talk to the same Express API and the same Supabase database, so a parcel created on iOS shows up on the web admin console seconds later, and vice-versa.

The mental model: the web app is the *desk* — full keyboard, big screens, deep workflows like consolidations and customs paperwork. The iOS app is the *floor* — phone in hand, scanning labels in the warehouse, capturing proof-of-delivery photos at the door, and quickly checking parcel status while on the move.

Roles in one sentence each

- **Customer.** The person whose parcel it is. Creates orders, tracks them, pays.
- **Operator.** Hub staff at Stockport. Receives parcels, prints SKU labels, builds consolidations, prints manifests.
- **Shipping agent.** Clears parcels through Kenyan customs and uploads PVOC paperwork.
- **Rider.** Picks up the cleared parcel from the Nairobi hub and delivers it.
- **Admin.** Owns the system. Sees everything, can override anything, sets pricing.

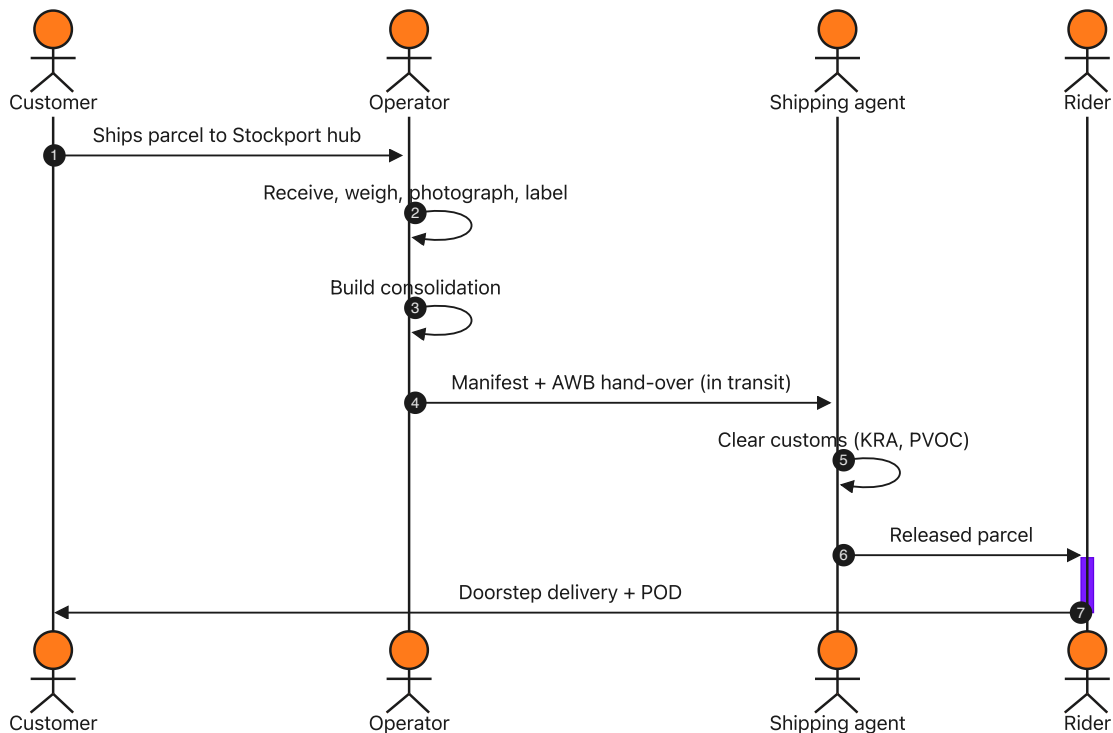
2 · The shape of a parcel's journey

Every parcel passes through the same eight states, in the same order. Most of the rest of this manual is just "what does each role do at each step."



The status on the parcel never goes backwards under normal flow. The two exceptions are *held* (pulled out by screening or operator decision) and *cancelled* (customer-initiated before the parcel reaches the hub).

Who acts when



3 · The iOS app and the web app

A customer can do everything from either the iOS app or the website. This section walks through the most common five tasks.

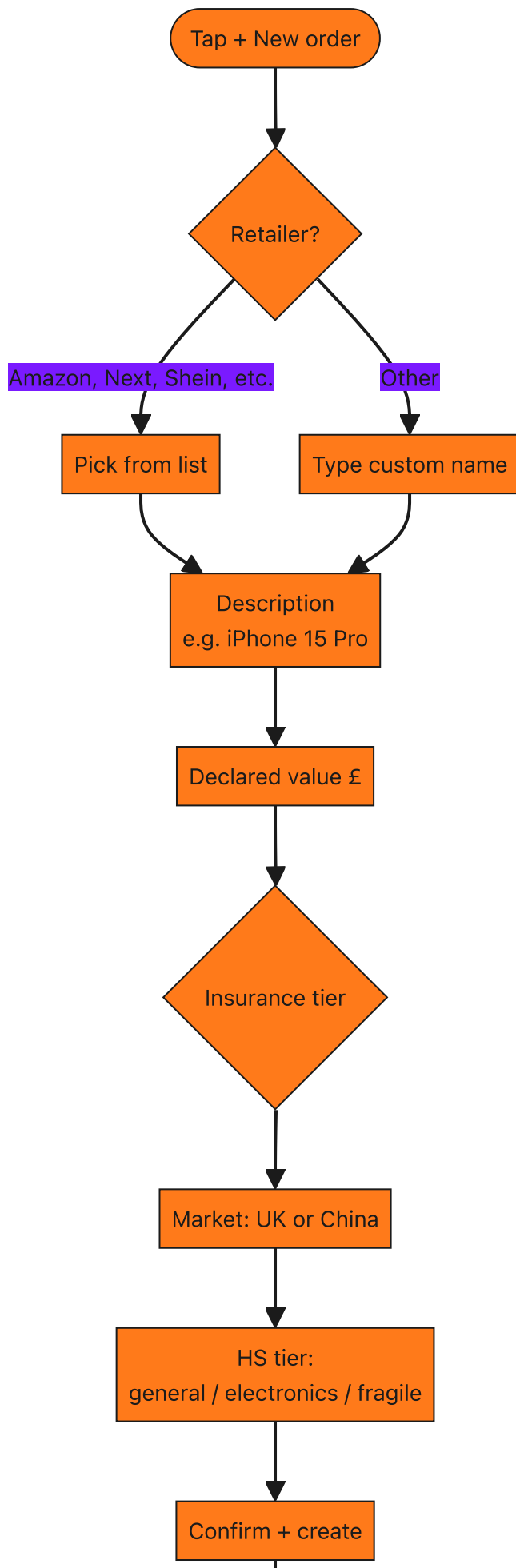
3.1 · Creating an account

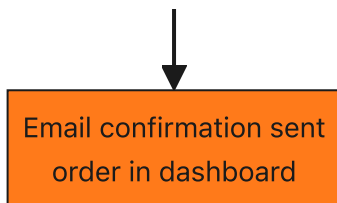
1. **1 Open the app or visit the website.** Tap "Register" (web) or "Create account" (iOS).
2. **2 Fill in name, email, phone, password.** Phone goes in international format (e.g. `+254712345678`) so SMS receipts can reach you.
3. **3 Confirm.** The system mints you a unique **warehouse ID** in the form `TC-XXXX` . This is the code you write on every parcel you send to Stockport — it's how the hub matches a box to your account.
4. **4 Sign in.** The first sign-in stays signed in for 30 days; if you sign out, biometrics speed it back up.

Where to find your warehouse ID: on the iOS app it's at the top of the *Account* tab. On the web it's in the dashboard header. Always include this code on outgoing parcels.

3.2 · Creating a new order

An order is the data record we use to expect, receive, charge for, and track a parcel. You always create an order *before* the parcel reaches the warehouse — that way we know to expect it.





1. **1 Open the order form.** iOS: tap the orange "+" floating button on the Home tab. Web: click *New order* from the dashboard.
2. **2 Pick the retailer.** If you don't see it in the list, tap "Other" and type the name. The retailer name is what an operator sees on the warehouse shelf — the more accurate it is, the faster the match.
3. **3 Describe the item.** One short phrase ("iPhone 15", "Boxers", "Hair products"). Avoid the word "Item".
4. **4 Declared value (£).** What the goods are worth. This drives KRA customs duty and your insurance cover.
5. **5 Insurance tier.** Standard is included. Plus, Premier and Custom add cover at a per-tier premium — pricing shown on screen before you confirm.
6. **6 Market and HS tier.** Market is where the parcel ships from (UK air, China air, UK sea). HS tier picks the broad customs band — "general" for clothing & books, "electronics" for phones & laptops, "fragile" for glassware.
7. **7 Confirm.** A confirmation email arrives within a minute. The order shows up on your dashboard with status *pending* and a tracking number like **TC-20260429-AB12**.

Don't ship before you create the order. If a box arrives at the hub without a matching order in the system, an operator has to chase you for the details — that adds days to your delivery.

3.3 · Tracking a parcel

You have three places to see status:

- **Home dashboard** — the latest five parcels with a chip showing current status.
- **Tracking tab (iOS) / Track Package (web)** — the full timeline view: when it was received, photographed, manifested, when the flight left, when it cleared customs, when the rider was assigned, when it landed.
- **Public tracking link** — the email confirmation contains a no-login link you can share with whoever is receiving the parcel on your behalf.

3.4 · Wallet, top-ups, and paying for delivery

Your wallet holds balance you've added (M-Pesa or card). When a parcel is consolidated, the system computes the total charge (freight + duty + insurance + fees) and debits the wallet. If the wallet is short, the parcel is held at *awaiting duty payment* until you top it up.

1. **1 Open the Wallet tab.** Current balance and the last twenty transactions are shown.
2. **2 Top up.** Tap "Add funds" → choose M-Pesa or Card → enter amount → confirm. M-Pesa pushes a STK prompt to the phone number on your account; cards run via Stripe.
3. **3 Watch the live banner.** Once the payment confirms, the wallet refreshes within a few seconds (admin sees the same event).

3.5 · The Quote calculator

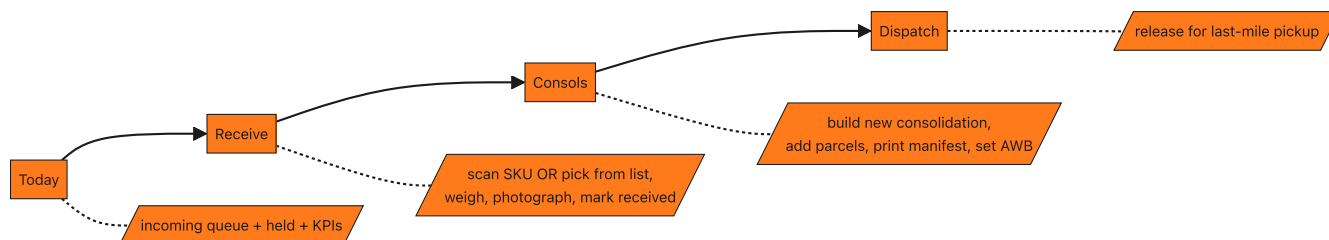
Use it before you ship anything to know what you'll be charged. Pick market (UK air / China air / UK sea), enter weight or dimensions (the calculator uses whichever is heavier — actual or volumetric), pick HS tier, and the calculator shows freight, duty, fees, and an all-in total in £ and KSh.

3.6 · Support, FAQ, and prohibited items

- **FAQ** on the web is the first stop for general questions.
- **Prohibited items** — open the searchable list before you ship anything that might be questionable. The list flags *prohibited*, *restricted*, and *dangerous-goods-suspect* categories.
- **Support tickets** — open one from the iOS Support tab or the web Support page. Replies appear as iMessage-style bubbles in the same screen.
- **WhatsApp** — fastest for time-sensitive issues. There's a button right on the customer Home that opens WhatsApp to `+44 7424 531483` with a pre-filled message including your order number.

4 · Running the Stockport hub

Operators are at the warehouse all day. The iOS app is built for them — five tabs that walk linearly through a parcel's life from arriving at the door to going out on a flight.



4.1 · The Today tab

Opens to a five-card snapshot of the warehouse:

- **Expected today** — orders created in the last 14 days that haven't been received yet.
- **Received** — parcels currently on the floor, status *received_at_warehouse*.
- **Consolidating** — already attached to an open consolidation.
- **In transit** — already on a flight.
- **Held** — flagged by screening or by an operator. Click through to see the reason.

4.2 · The Receive flow

This is the most-used screen of any role. There are now **two** ways to start it.

From the queue

1. **1** Open the *Receive* tab.
2. **2** Match the parcel on the table to a row by description / sender / customer name.
3. **3** Tap the row.

By scanning

1. **1** Tap the orange *Scan SKU* button.
2. **2** Point the camera at any printed STK-XXXXXX label.
3. **3** If pre-registered → Receive sheet opens. Otherwise → detail panel.

Both paths land on the same Receive sheet. From there:

1. **1** **Confirm the customer.** Top of the screen shows the full name and the personal warehouse code (TC-XXXX). If it doesn't match what's on the box, stop and contact admin.

2. **2 Re-mint the SKU if you need to.** The "Re-mint" button issues a fresh `STK-XXXXXX` ; the old printed label becomes invalid as soon as you mark received with the new one.
3. **3 Type the dimensions and weight.** Length, width, height in cm; weight in kg. Defaults are 30/20/20/1 — overwrite them.
4. **4 Tap Print Label.** AirPrint dialog opens; pick the warehouse Brother / Zebra printer. Stick the printed label on the box (always cover any retailer labels).
5. **5 Tap Mark Received.** Status flips to *received_at_warehouse*, the customer's tracking page updates, and the parcel is now eligible for consolidation.

Why we re-mint: if a customer accidentally re-printed an old label or a previous staff member voided it, mint a fresh one. Only the latest SKU on a parcel is valid.

4.3 · Building a consolidation (Consols tab)

A consolidation is a group of parcels going on the same flight. There is no fixed weekly cadence — operators create them on demand based on volume and flight availability.

1. **1** Open the *Consols* tab and tap *+ New consolidation*.
2. **2** Pick the market (UK air, China air, UK sea) and enter the planned departure date.
3. **3** Open the new consolidation and tap *Add parcels to manifest* — multi-select from the "ready" list.
4. **4** When the consolidation is closed (no more parcels), tap *Print manifest* — produces a paginated A4 PDF with parcel list, weights, declared values, totals, and a KRA-customs reminder footer.
5. **5** Enter the *master AWB* (the air-waybill number from the airline) and tap *Submit AWB & mark in-transit*. Every parcel in the manifest flips to *in_transit*.

4.4 · The Dispatch tab

Once cleared at the Nairobi hub, parcels show up here ready for last-mile pickup. An operator (or admin) attaches a rider to a run and the parcels disappear from the queue as the rider takes them out.

4.5 · Held parcels

If a screening flags a parcel (the Receive flow runs the *prohibited items* check on the description), or an operator manually puts a parcel on hold, it sits in the *held* bucket on Today. From the parcel's detail view you can:

- **Release** — put it back into the normal flow (e.g. customer provided a missing PVOC document).
- **Re-screen** — re-run the prohibited check, e.g. after the description was updated.
- **Cancel** — escalates to admin; only admins close a held parcel for good.

5 · Shipping agent (customs & clearance)

Shipping agents pick up consolidations after the flight lands at JKIA, run them through KRA and any required PVOC paperwork, and release the parcels for last-mile delivery. The agent app has a focused two-tab layout — *Customs* and *Invoices*.

5.1 · The Customs queue

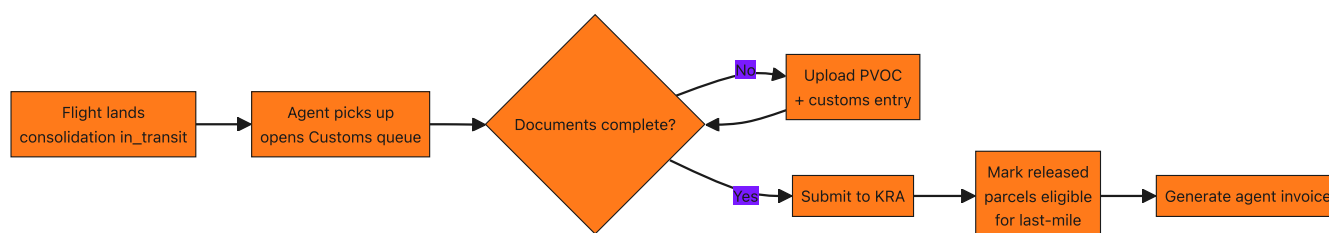
- 1 Open the *Customs* tab. Each row is a consolidation that has landed and is awaiting clearance.
- 2 Tap a row to open. You see the manifest (every parcel with declared value, weight, HS tier), the master AWB, and any uploaded PVOC documents.
- 3 Upload PVOC certificates and the customs entry. Each upload attaches to the parent consolidation; the customer sees a generic "in customs" status without seeing the document set.
- 4 When KRA releases the consolidation, mark it *cleared*. All child parcels flip to *released* and become eligible for last-mile.

5.2 · Invoices

Each consolidation generates an agent invoice covering customs duty, agent fees, and any per-parcel charges. The Invoices tab lists them with status *draft* / *sent* / *paid* and lets you push a sent invoice to admin for reconciliation.

Where the data goes: the agent's uploads land in the `pvoc_documents` and `customs_entries` tables; admin sees the same files on the web Customs view. Customers don't see the documents themselves — they see the high-level "in customs" / "released" status only.

5.3 · Workflow diagram



6 · Last-mile rider

Riders are on a phone almost exclusively. The iOS app has two tabs that matter — *Today* (the run) and *Outbox* (offline-queued POD captures).

6.1 · Starting a run

1. **1** Open the *Today* tab. The run admin assigned to you opens automatically — list of stops in optimised delivery order with addresses + phone numbers.
2. **2** Tap a stop to expand. You see the parcel SKU, recipient name, declared value, special instructions, and a one-tap call/WhatsApp button.
3. **3** Tap *Navigate* — opens Apple Maps to the address.

6.2 · Capturing proof of delivery

1. **1** At the door, tap *Mark delivered*.
2. **2** Take a photo of the parcel handed to the recipient (or in their hands).
3. **3** Capture a signature on screen (recipient draws with a finger).
4. **4** Confirm. The parcel flips to *delivered*, the customer gets a "delivered" notification + the photo, and the next stop slides up the list.

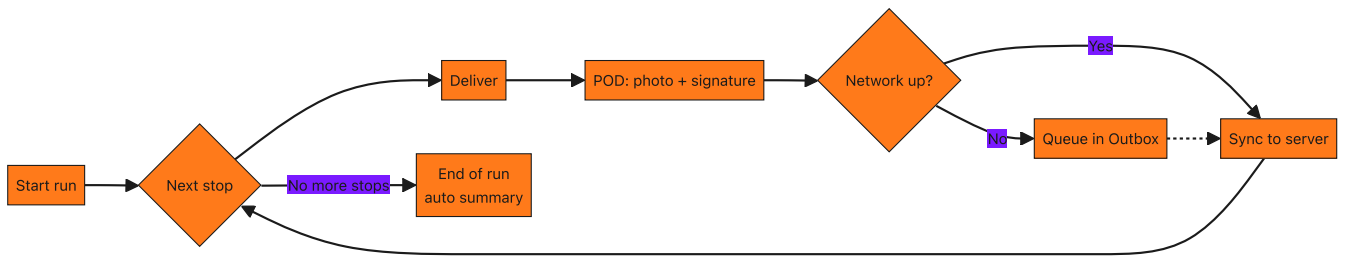
6.3 · The Outbox (offline mode)

Phone networks in Nairobi traffic are unreliable. Every POD capture writes to a local outbox first, then syncs when network is back. The Outbox tab shows you the queue — a yellow chip means it's still queued, a green chip means it landed on the server.

If you see a stuck queue, check the device's data connection. As long as the rider is signed in and the queue is visible, the captures are safe — they will sync when the network returns.

6.4 · End of day

When the last stop is delivered, the run auto-closes. The rider sees a one-line summary: stops completed, distance, on-time rate. Admin sees the same summary in the KPI dashboard.



7 · Running the company

Admins use both the web app (deeper screens, more keyboard) and the iOS app (quick checks while away from desk). The five iOS tabs are *Console*, *KPI*, *Consols*, *Settings*, *Account*.

7.1 · Admin Console

The single screen that lists every order, parcel, customer, payment, ticket, and error log. Has filter bars across the top and per-row actions:

- **Orders** — see status chip, declared value, customer, retailer; cancel an order with a reason; send a payment reminder; edit declared value.
- **Customers** — search by email/phone/warehouse code; impersonate (read-only); resend the welcome email.
- **Payments** — pending wallet top-ups appear here with the M-Pesa SMS proof inline. Approve or reject with a reason — both update the wallet and email the customer.
- **Tickets** — open support conversations with iMessage-style bubbles. Reply inline; mark resolved.
- **Error logs** — server errors, with stack and request context. Useful for triaging customer complaints.
- **Email logs** — outbound email audit (subject, recipient, status). Great for "did the confirmation email actually go out?" questions.

7.2 · KPI dashboard

Six top-level numbers update live from the database:

- Active customers (last 30 d).
- Orders created this week.
- Parcels in transit.
- Average end-to-end time (created → delivered).
- NPS score (rolling 30 d, customer survey on delivery).
- Revenue this month (sum of paid invoices).

7.3 · Ops Settings

Where pricing actually lives. Three sub-screens:

- **Pricing tiers** — per market and weight band (UK_air 0-1kg, 1-5kg, ...). Edit the per-kg rate, the active flag, and whether it's a percentage. Changes are live immediately.

- **Fees** — flat fees (handling, fuel surcharge, KRA fee). Inline edit label/code/amount/active/percentage.
- **Exchange rates** — pairs USD/GBP/EUR/CNY → KES. Edit per-pair or "Save all".

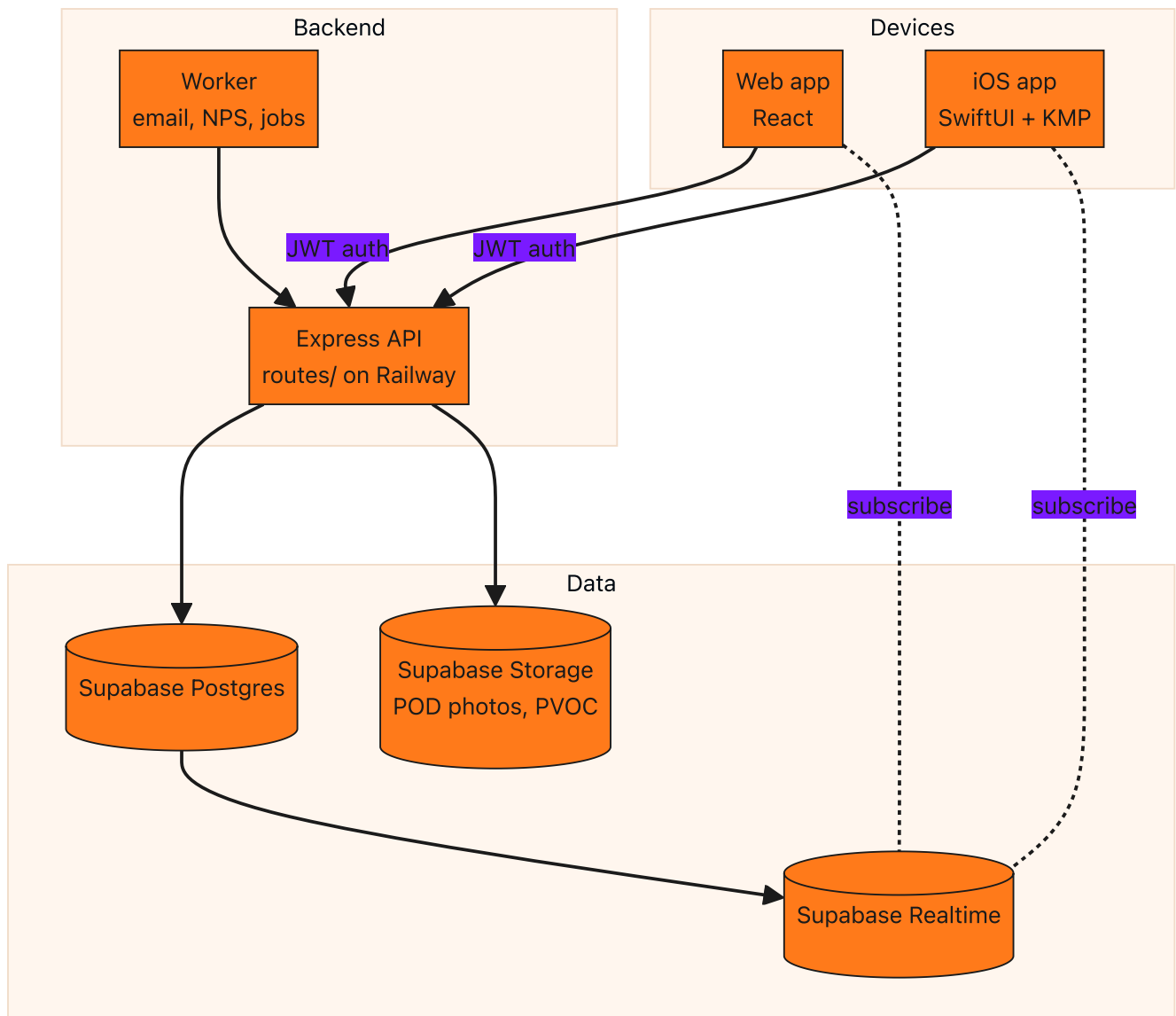
Pricing changes apply to new orders only. Already-priced orders keep their original quote until manually re-quoted from the order detail page.

7.4 • Approving a wallet top-up

1. **1** Open the *Console* tab → *Payments* sub-tab.
2. **2** Pending row shows the customer, amount, the raw M-Pesa SMS body the customer pasted, and the wallet snapshot.
3. **3** Verify the SMS code against the M-Pesa portal.
4. **4** Approve → wallet credited, customer emailed. Reject → require a reason; customer emailed and a banner shown next time they sign in.

7.5 • Architecture at a glance

If you're new to the system, this is what's running under the hood:



The Express API is the only thing that writes to the database. Both apps read live updates over Realtime. RLS policies on every table mean a customer's JWT can only read their own rows; staff JWTs can read all.

7.6 · Daily/weekly cadence

Cadence	What to do	Where
Every morning	Skim error logs and email logs from the previous 24 h	Console → Errors / Emails
Every morning	Approve pending payments	Console → Payments
Every Monday	Review NPS responses + open tickets	KPI + Console → Tickets
Every consolidation	Spot-check an operator's manifest before AWB submit	Web → Ops → Consolidations

Cadence	What to do	Where
Monthly	Review pricing tiers vs. carrier rates	Settings → Pricing
Pre-launch / quarterly	Run the Supabase linter; address security findings	Studio → Database → Linter

8 · Troubleshooting & common questions

8.1 · "I can't sign in"

- **Wrong password** → "Forgot password" sends a reset link to your email.
- **Email not recognised** → check the address you used to register; warehouse-code-only lookups don't work for sign-in.
- **Session expired** → sign in again. Sessions last 30 days.

8.2 · "My parcel isn't on the dashboard"

- Pull to refresh on the iOS Home tab; the realtime subscription occasionally drops on a poor network.
- Check the email confirmation — if it never arrived, the order didn't actually land. Try creating it again.

8.3 · "The operator says my warehouse code doesn't match"

This means the box arrived without the right TC-XXXX code or with someone else's. Open a support ticket immediately with photos of the box and the courier label. Admin can re-link the box on the back end.

8.4 · Operator: "Mark received fails"

The Receive sheet shows a red "Couldn't save — no order found" banner. This means the package row in the database isn't linked to an order (legacy data from before the orders-routing fix). Contact admin — they have a backfill script that links it back.

8.5 · Operator: "The scanner says 'no parcel with that SKU'"

- The SKU was re-minted on a later print; only the most recent label is valid. Re-print and re-scan.
- The receive call never landed (e.g. earlier failure). Use the Receive tab's queue to find the parcel by description and re-run the receive flow.

8.6 · Rider: "POD photo isn't uploading"

- The Outbox tab shows a yellow chip — it's queued and will sync when network returns.
- If the chip stays yellow for >30 minutes, sign out and sign back in. The queue persists across sessions.

8.7 · Admin: "A customer paid via M-Pesa but balance didn't update"

That's by design — wallet credits happen only after admin approval. Open Console → Payments, find the pending row, verify the SMS, and approve.

8.8 · Where to file a bug

Two places:

- The error log auto-captures server-side issues — review them in Console → Errors.
- For a UX bug a customer hit, open a support ticket on their behalf from Console → Tickets, link the parcel, and tag `bug`.

9 · Glossary

Term	Meaning
AWB	Air waybill — the airline's identifier for a consolidation.
Chargeable kg	The greater of actual weight and volumetric weight ($L \times W \times H / 6000$). What we charge by.
Consolidation	A bundle of parcels travelling on the same flight under one master AWB.
HS tier	A simplified Harmonised System bucket — general / electronics / fragile — driving customs duty.
KRA	Kenya Revenue Authority — the customs counter-party.
Manifest	The printed A4 sheet listing every parcel in a consolidation. Goes with the AWB.
POD	Proof of delivery — the photo + signature a rider captures at the door.
PVOC	Pre-export Verification of Conformity — KRA paperwork required for some categories.
SKU label	The STK-XXXXXX sticker an operator prints and applies in the warehouse.
Volumetric kg	$(\text{Length} \times \text{Width} \times \text{Height}) \text{ cm} \div 6000$. The dimensional-weight equivalent.
Warehouse ID	The TC-XXXX code unique to each customer; written on every outgoing parcel.